

process of developing proprietary tools.

Next, I got to look in on the Mozilla Camp. Seth Bindernagel and Arun Ranganathan co-hosted the camp. It started from the history of Mozilla and how it was born from Netscape, and progressed to quite an interesting and interactive discussion focusing on the recent release of Bepin, followed by a demonstration on Bepin.

I then got to listen to Alolita Sharma, who focused on one distinguishing characteristic of open source—of users becoming the contributors and the resulting decentralisation of ownership, synergies between the people of different cultures, the give and take of polite feedback rather than blame games, etc. The talk was also backed up with case studies of three important open source projects—WordPress, Ubuntu and Mozilla Firefox.

The talk titled *FREEconomics: The economics of free/open source* by Navin Kabra was also insightful. As the name suggests, it was all about the business model of FOSS-based companies. He highlighted the characteristic economics behind 'free and open source software products'. He concluded by putting forward an interesting and important idea about the 'Attention Economy/ Reputation Economy'.

The last talk I sat through was on 'My experience with Linux as a customer' by Atul Tulshibagwale. The speaker focused on the gaps in the current Linux distributions, which make the Indian audience hesitate to use it as their desktop OS. He emphasised the important applications that still need to be ported, and how the small but smart changes in default configurations of applications like OpenOffice.org would make the transition comfortable for the Indian audience.

Finally, before leaving for the day, I sneaked a peek into the Marathi Localisation activity room. What was in progress was a session on 'FUEL-Frequently Used Entries for Localisation', by G Karunakar and Sandeep Shedmake. I noticed a number of Marathi wits translating and verifying the 'correct and closest' translations for the different terminology in OpenOffice.org, making it easy to understand for local people. This was a two-day ongoing activity and covered more than 250 terms (as per the last word count that I heard about). I contributed a few and left for the day.

All in all, I'd say the organisers and volunteers worked really hard to make sure the event was yet another success story in the history of GNUnify. By the way, have you visited gnunify.in yet? 

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